MongoDB + Mongoose

MERN Integration & Deployment

MODULE 5 · DAY 5 – BACKEND DATA LAYER

Build and integrate a database with a full MERN stack application over 6 focused hours.

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OVERVIEW

What is MongoDB?

MongoDB is a NoSQL database that stores data in a flexible, JSON-like format (BSON). Unlike traditional relational databases, it requires no strict table structure and is designed for scalability and high performance.

NoSQL Database

Stores data as BSON documents — a binary, JSON-like format — rather than rows and columns.

Flexible Schema

No rigid table structure required. Documents in the same collection can have different fields.

High Performance

Designed for scalability and speed, supporting horizontal scaling across distributed systems.

Example Document

A record like `{ name: "John", age: 25, skills: ["JavaScript", "React"] }` is a single MongoDB document.

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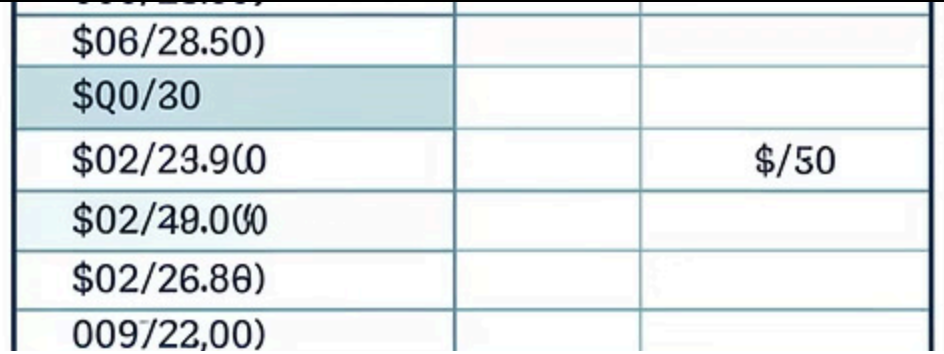

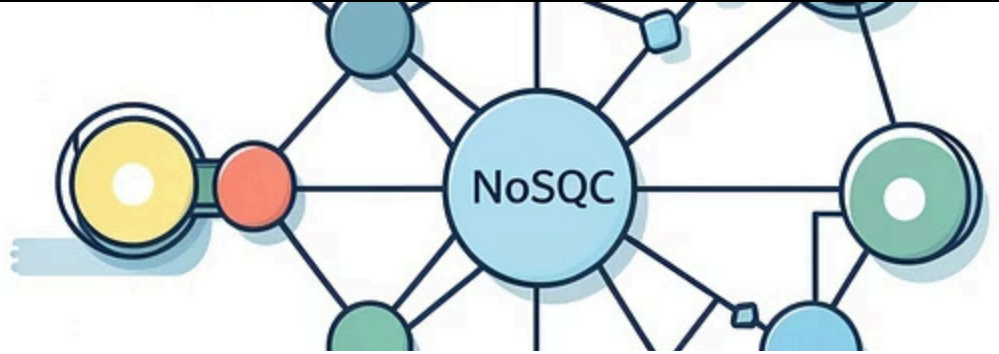

CONCEPTS

SQL vs NoSQL

Understanding the key differences between relational and non-relational databases helps you choose the right tool. MongoDB excels for dynamic applications like e-commerce and social platforms.

Feature	SQL	NoSQL (MongoDB)
Structure	Tables	Collections
Schema	Fixed	Flexible
Scaling	Vertical	Horizontal
Query Language	SQL	JSON-like operators
Relationships	Foreign keys & joins	Embedded or referenced

SQL maps to MongoDB as: **database → database**, **tables → collections**, **rows → documents (BSON)**, **columns → fields**.

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STRUCTURE

MongoDB Core Concepts

MongoDB organizes data in a clear three-level hierarchy. Understanding this structure is the foundation for all database operations in your MERN application.

Database

The top-level container. Contains one or more collections. Example: `ecommerce`

Collection

A group of related documents, analogous to a table. Example: `products`

Document

A single JSON-like record. Example: `{name: "Shirt", price: 999}`

Hierarchy: **Database → Collection → Document**

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OPERATIONS

MongoDB CRUD Operations

CRUD stands for Create, Read, Update, and Delete — the four fundamental operations for interacting with any database. MongoDB provides dedicated shell commands for each.

Create

insert(), save()

```
db.users.insertOne({name: "Parth"})
```

Read

find(), findOne()

```
db.users.find()
```

Update

updateOne(), updateMany()

```
db.users.updateOne({name:"Parth"},{$set:{age:25}})
```

Delete

deleteOne(), deleteMany()

```
db.users.deleteOne({name:"Parth"})
```

Practice all four operations in the MongoDB Shell before moving to Mongoose. Mastering raw commands builds intuition for ODM behavior.

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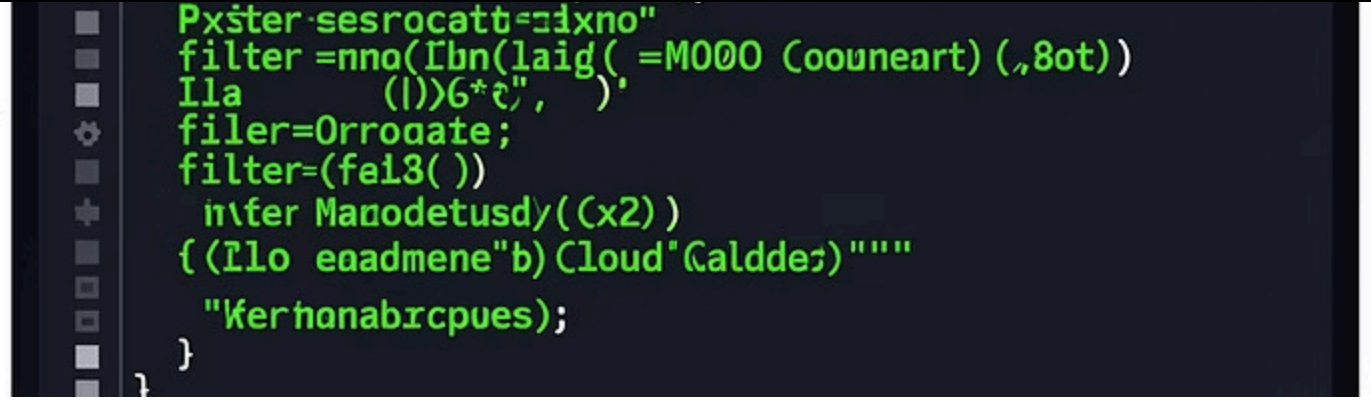

QUERIES

Advanced Queries in MongoDB

Beyond basic CRUD, MongoDB supports powerful query operators for filtering, sorting, and limiting results — essential for building real-world features like product filtering by price or category.

Query Operators

- **Equality:** db.users.find({age: 25})
- **Greater Than ($gt):** db.users.find({age: {$gt: 20}})
- **Less Than ($lt):** db.users.find({age: {$lt: 30}})
- **In Array ($in):** db.users.find({role: {$in: ["admin","user"]}})

Sorting & Limiting

- **Sort Descending:** db.users.find().sort({age: -1})
- **Sort Ascending:** db.users.find().sort({age: 1})
- **Limit Results:** db.users.find().limit(5)

Use Case: Filter products by price range or category in an e-commerce app.

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ODM LAYER

What is Mongoose?

Mongoose is an Object Data Modeling (ODM) library for MongoDB and Node.js. It adds a structured, schema-based layer on top of the raw MongoDB driver, resulting in cleaner, more maintainable backend code.

Data Validation

Enforce required fields, types, and constraints before data ever touches the database.

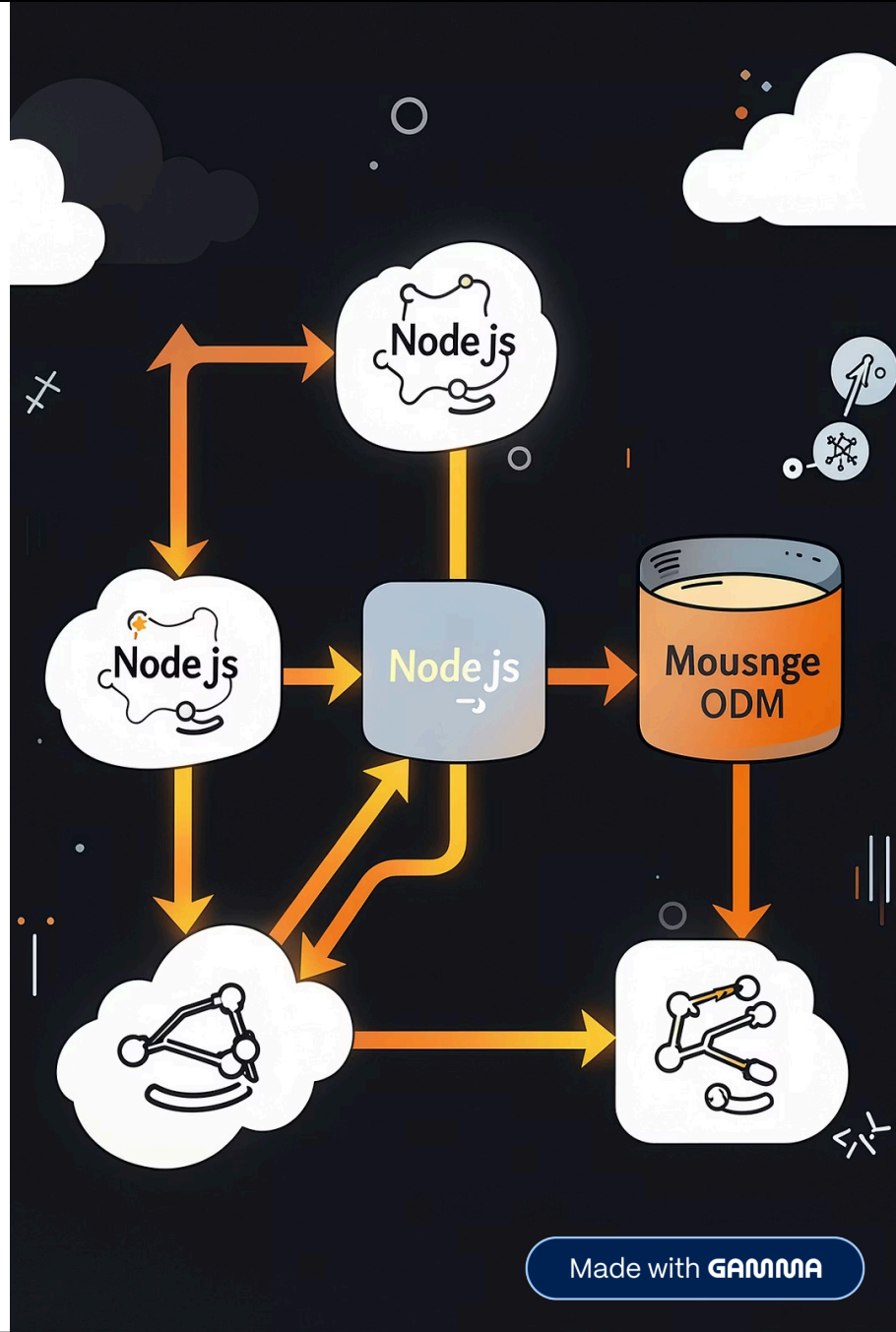
Schema-Based Design

Define the shape of your documents up front, making your data model explicit and predictable.

Cleaner Code

Mongoose replaces verbose MongoDB driver calls with expressive, readable JavaScript models and methods.

Flow: **Node.js → Mongoose (Object Mapping) → Mongo Driver → MongoDB**



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SETUP

Mongoose Setup, Schema & Validation

Getting Mongoose connected and your first schema defined are the two critical steps to a working data layer. Once connected, schemas define the structure and validation rules for every document your app creates.

Installation & Connection

```
npm install mongoose
```

```
const mongoose = require('mongoose');
mongoose.connect(
  'mongodb://127.0.0.1:27017/testDB'
)
.then(() => console.log("Connected"))
.catch(err => console.log(err));
```

Schema, Model & Validation

```
const userSchema = new mongoose.Schema({
  name: String,
  age: Number,
  email: {
    type: String,
    required: true
  }
});

const User = mongoose.model(
  'User', userSchema
);
```

Schema

Defines the structure and field types of a document.

Model

The JavaScript interface used to query and write to the collection.

Validation

Ensures only correct, complete data is saved to the database.

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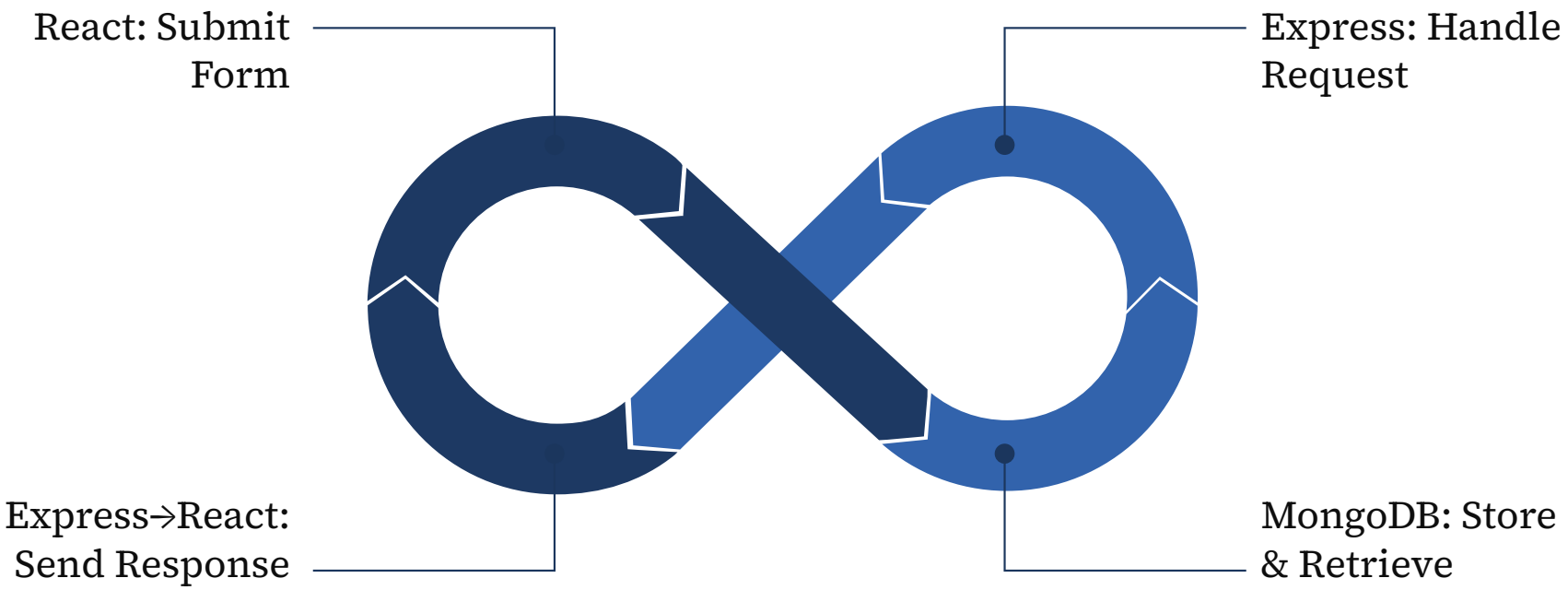
INTEGRATION

MERN Stack Integration

With MongoDB and Mongoose in place, the full MERN stack is connected. Data flows from the React front end, through Express routes and Node.js middleware, to MongoDB — and back — in a seamless loop.



Every layer has a single responsibility: React manages UI, Express handles routing, Node runs the server, and MongoDB persists data via Mongoose models.

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OUTCOME

Mini Task: Build a Product API

By the end of Day 5, students will have a fully operational CRUD backend connected to MongoDB via Mongoose, wired into their MERN application, and ready for deployment.

Add Product

Create a POST route using `Product.create(req.body)` to insert a new product document into MongoDB.

View Products

Build a GET route using `Product.find()` to return all products to the React front end.

Update Price

Wire a PUT route using `Product.findByIdAndUpdate()` to modify an existing product's price field.

Delete Product

Implement a DELETE route using `Product.findByIdAndDelete()` to remove a product from the database.

What students achieve: Full CRUD backend · Mongoose models with validation · API connected to MongoDB · MERN stack ready for deployment

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